



# **Introduction to quality and safety in health care**

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# Overview of Quality and Safety in Healthcare

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Quality and safety are fundamental components of healthcare, **ensuring patients receive effective, efficient, care while minimizing harm.**



**Definition of Quality:** Doing the **right thing at the right time in the right way** to achieve the best possible results.

# WHO definition of quality of care

- it is the extent to which the health care services provided to individuals and patient populations **improve desired health outcomes, to achieve this, health care must be safe, effectiveفعال, timed, efficientكفاءة, equitableعادل and patient centered.**

# Dimensions of quality:

1. **Safe**: delivering health care that minimizes risks, harm to service users including avoiding preventable injuries.
2. **Effectiveness**فعالية : Providing evidence-based care that achieves desired outcomes.
3. **Efficiency**كفاءة : Optimizing resource utilization to minimize or avoid waste.
4. **Timed**: Delivering care promptly and reducing waiting times (reduce delay).
5. **Equitable**: - Delivering health care that doesn't differ in quality according to personal characteristics such as gender, race, ethnicity or socioeconomic status. Ensuring care is accessible, unbiased, and culturally sensitive.
6. **Patient-centered & (value-based care)**: Focusing on individual patient needs, values, and preferences.

1. **Preventing harm:** Minimizing errors, adverse events, and injuries.
2. **Mitigating risk** تخفيف المخاطر: Identifying and addressing potential hazards.
3. **Promoting a safety culture:** Encouraging transparency الشفافية, accountability المساءلة, and continuous improvement.

# Importance of Quality and Safety in Healthcare

1. **Patient outcomes:** High quality, safe care improves patient outcomes, reduces morbidity, and mortality.

2. **Patient satisfaction:** Quality care enhances patient satisfaction, trust, and loyalty. وفاء

3. **Cost reduction:** Preventing errors, reducing complications, and optimizing resource utilization decrease healthcare costs.

4. **Professional reputation:** Healthcare organizations and professionals' benefit from a reputation for delivering high-quality, safe care.

5. **Regulatory compliance:** Meeting quality and safety standards ensures compliance with regulatory requirement.

# Key Quality and Safety Concepts:

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**1. Patient-centered care:** Care that respects patients' values, preferences, and needs.



**2. Evidence-based practice:** Care that incorporates the best available research evidence.



**3. Continuous quality improvement:** Ongoing efforts to improve care processes and outcomes.



**4. Safety culture:** A culture that prioritizes safety, encourages reporting, and learns from errors.



**5. Just culture:** A culture that balances accountability with learning and improvement.

# Quality improvement

- The framework that is used to systematically **improve the ways care is delivered to patients** and this process has characteristics; measured, analyzed, controlled & improved.



# Accreditation initiatives that integrate quality and safety standers include(non-profit):

1. The Joint Commission's International (JCI) accreditation standards, American initiatives focus on quality, safety and patient centered care.
2. The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services' (CMS) quality initiatives emphasize quality, safety, and value-based care.
3. The Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality's (AHRQ) patient safety programs: focus on safety, quality and evidence-based practice.

4. The Institute for Healthcare Improvement's (**IHI**) quality and safety initiatives emphasize **quality, safety, continuous improvement**.

5. The Saudi Central Board for Accreditation of Healthcare Institutions **CEBAHI**  
Achieving CBAHI accreditation is mandatory for all healthcare facilities in Saudi Arabia.

5. The General Authority for Healthcare Accreditation and Regulation (**GAHAR**)  
Egyptian quality initiatives focuses on **quality of care, patient safety and competency**.

# The relationship between quality and safety in healthcare.



*Quality and safety are interdependent, intertwined, with each influencing the other:*



**1. Quality drives safety:** High-quality care reduces errors, adverse events, and harm.



**2. Safety enhances quality:** A safety-focused culture promotes transparency, accountability, and continuous improvement, ultimately enhancing quality.

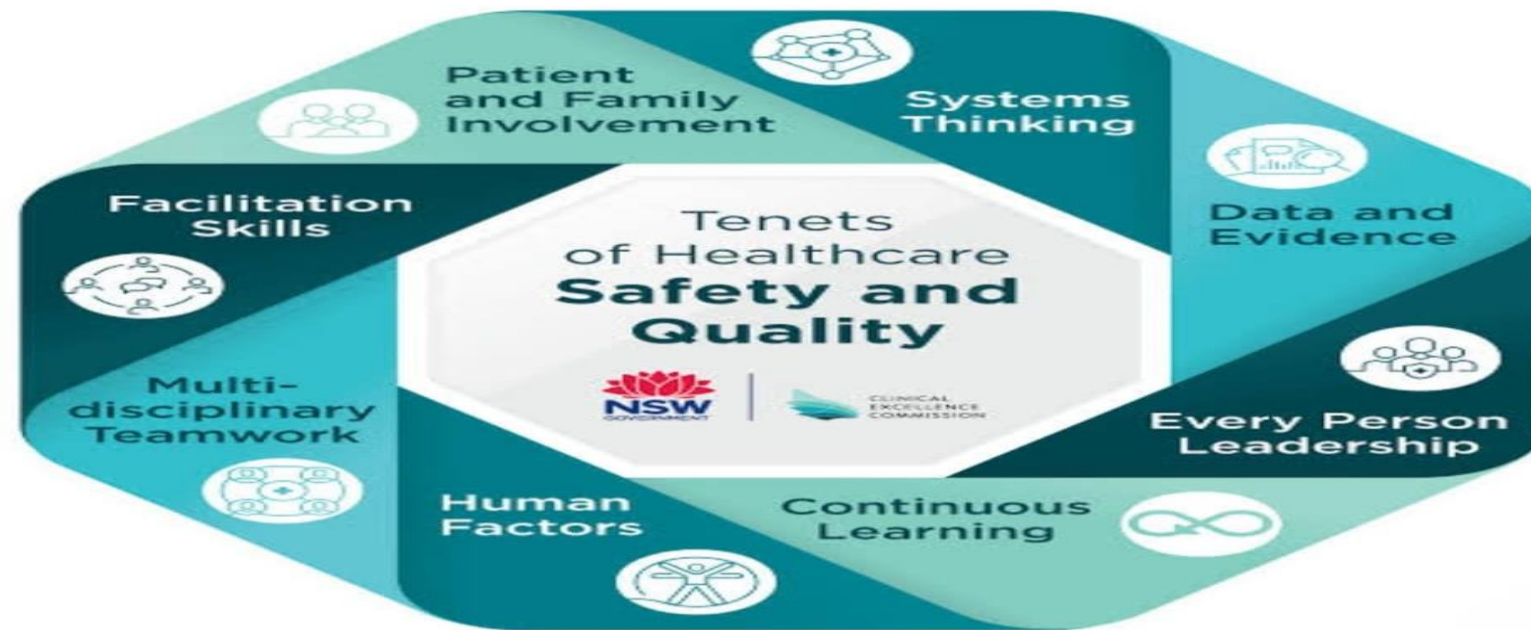


**3. Shared goals:** Quality and safety share common goals, such as improving patient outcomes, reducing harm, and optimizing resource utilization.

# Strategies for Improving Quality and Safety



# Tenets of Health care Quality and safety:



# Challenges and Opportunities facing Quality and safety:



**1. Complexity of healthcare systems:** Multiple stakeholders, processes, and technologies.



**2. Limited resources:** Financial, personnel, and technological constraints.



**3. Rapidly changing healthcare landscape:** new technologies, policies, and reimbursement models النماذج التعويضية



**4. Growing focus on value-based care:** Emphasis on quality, safety, and cost-effectiveness.